

Getting code-sale money to salesmen without a bank account in between

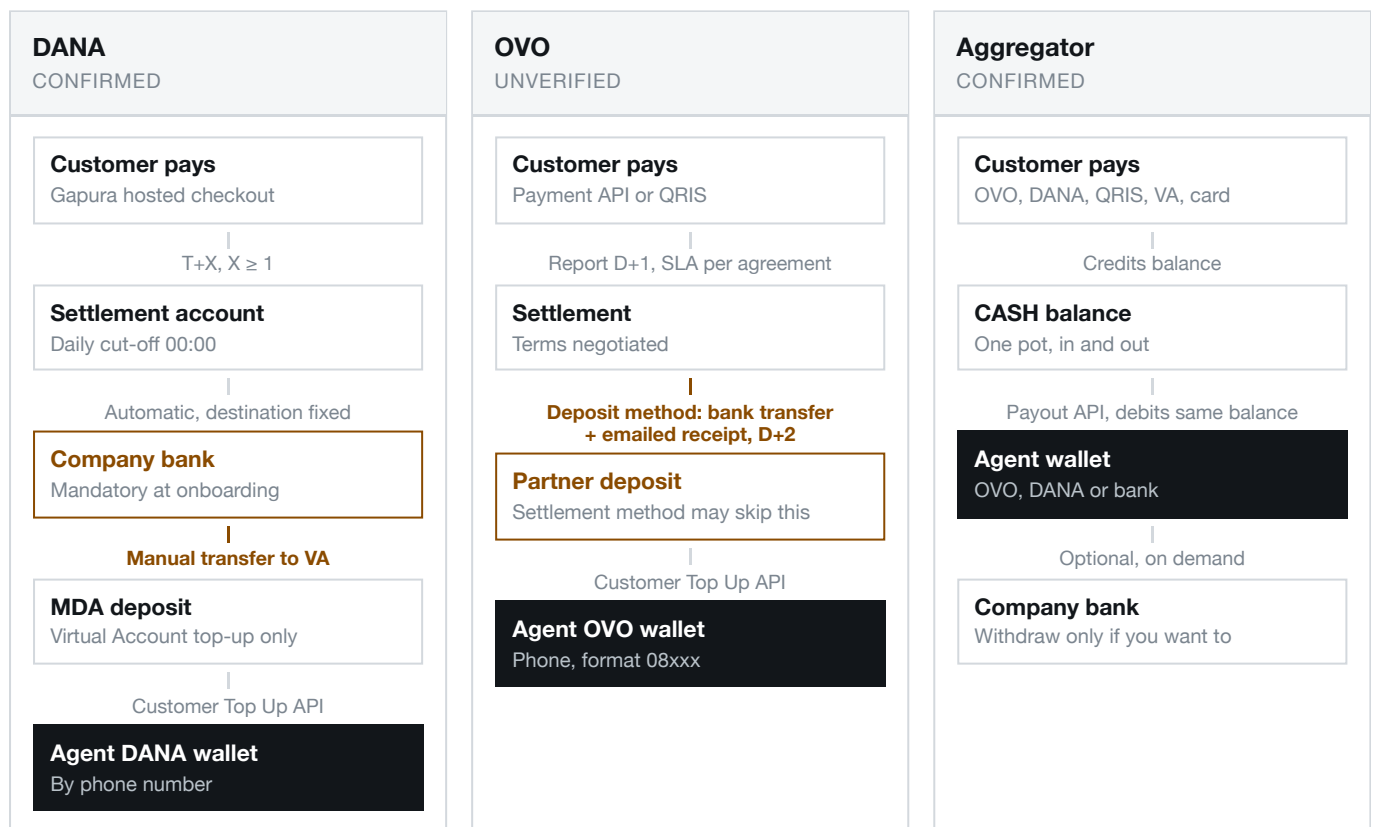
A comparison of DANA, OVO and an aggregator rail for collecting subscription-code payments and paying agent commission.

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DANA cannot do it. OVO might. An aggregator can, today.

DANA requires a settlement bank account as a condition of onboarding and funds its disbursement pool only by manual top-up. OVO documents a “settlement method” that appears to skip the prefunded deposit, but publishes no detail — it is a commercial conversation, not a documented product. A single-balance aggregator such as Xendit credits incoming payments and debits outgoing payouts against the same balance, which removes the bank account from the path entirely.

01 The three flows



Boxes outlined in amber are points where money sits in, or must pass through, a bank account. Amber connectors are manual steps requiring a person.

02 Side by side

	DANA	OVO	Aggregator (Xendit)
Bank account in the path	Required	Possibly avoidable	Not required
Money in and money out share a balance	No — two separate ledgers	Unclear	Yes — one CASH balance
Prefunding required	Yes, before every payout run	Yes on deposit method; unclear on settlement method	No, incoming sales fund payouts
Topping up the payout pool	Virtual Account, instant	Bank transfer, then email the receipt. D+2 to appear	Not applicable
Self-serve sandbox	Yes, start today	No, NDA first	Yes
Time to production credentials	~2 business days after documents	Up to 6 working days, after UAT and commercial agreement	Days
Recipient identified by	Phone, E.164	Phone, 08xxx format	Phone or bank account
Locks us to one wallet	Yes, agents need DANA	Yes, agents need OVO	No, agent chooses
Cost	Direct rates	Direct rates	Direct rates plus aggregator margin
Who holds our float	DANA, then our bank	OVO, then our bank	The aggregator

03 Why DANA cannot avoid the bank account

Three independent constraints, each from DANA's own documentation. Any one of them alone would be enough.

“Set up your settlement account to allow DANA to automatically transfer your sales proceeds to your bank account at the end of each day.”

Business verification — the settlement bank account is a required field before the account is approved

“Merchant Disbursement Account (MDA) will be automatically created for you to store your balance ... In production, simply top up via the Virtual Account (VA) displayed in Merchant Portal.”

Disbursement to Balance — this is the only documented funding route for the payout pool

DANA's own balance API treats the two sides as different pots: `MERCHANT_TOTAL_BALANCE` covers the payable and settlement accounts, `MERCHANT_DEPOSIT_BALANCE` covers the disbursement pool. No endpoint moves money between them.

CAVEAT WORTH STATING TO DANA

This is a limit of the published documentation, not proof of a product limit. Netting between settlement and disbursement is exactly the kind of arrangement that exists commercially and never appears in public API docs. It costs one email to ask.

04 What OVO actually offers

OVO publishes four integration products: Payment API, Push-to-Pay, Dynamic QRIS, and Consumer Topup. Consumer Topup — internally “Top Up Inventory” — is the disbursement product, and it works much like DANA's: inquire on a phone number, send, poll for status.

The finding that matters

OVO's Consumer Topup FAQ lists the mandatory API set twice, once per funding model, and the two lists differ:

*“If Partner used **deposit method** below is mandatory: ... 5. Check Deposit Balance:*

cashin/snap/v1.0/merchant/account/balance

*If Partner used **Settlement method** please use api below as mandatory: ... (deposit balance check absent)”*

Consumer Topup FAQ — the settlement model does not check a prefunded deposit before paying out

That implies OVO can disburse against settled receivables rather than a prefunded pool. DANA offers no equivalent. It is the single most promising finding in this research — and also the least documented: one sentence, no flow, no terms. OVO's settlement page says only that the SLA is “based on agreement”.

If we end up on deposit method instead

“Partner need to perform transfer deposit into the bank account that is stated in the OVO system, once done Partner can send the receipt of the transfer to ovoforbusiness@ovo.id, after it the funds will be adjusted within D+2 WH.”

Consumer Topup FAQ — funding the payout pool

A bank transfer, a receipt emailed to a shared inbox, and a two-day wait. This is materially worse than DANA's Virtual Account, which is instant.

Recipient limits — check these against actual agent earnings

OVO account tier	Maximum balance held	Maximum incoming per month
Club (unverified)	Rp 2,000,000	Rp 20,000,000
Premier (full KYC)	Rp 20,000,000	Rp 40,000,000

Per-transaction disbursement appears capped at Rp 10 million. An agent on a Club account can hold only Rp 2 juta — a good month would bounce. Every agent would need to be on Premier, which means each of them completing full KYC before they can be paid. That is an onboarding burden on people we do not employ.

Getting started is slow

There is no self-serve sandbox. The sequence is: sign an NDA, receive the technical documents, submit a public key, receive staging credentials (2 working days), build, UAT conducted by OVO staff (1 working day per platform), OVO reviews the result (2 working days), sign the commercial agreement, submit production key and IP addresses for whitelisting, then production credentials in up to 6 working days.

05 The aggregator route

An aggregator sits between us and every wallet. The relevant property is not the payment methods — it is the ledger design.

Xendit holds merchant funds in a balance with three account types, CASH, HOLDING and TAX. Incoming payments credit CASH. Per Xendit's API reference, the balance “is debited on any money out transaction, e.g. when performing disbursements or Xendit fees are charged.” Payouts reach Indonesian e-wallets — OVO and DANA included — as well as 140+ banks.

The consequence: a customer paying for a subscription code credits the same balance that a commission payout debits. Withdrawal to a company bank account becomes something we choose to do, not something that happens to the money on its way through.

What we give up

- **Margin.** The aggregator takes a cut on top of the underlying wallet rate. Published third-party figures are not reliable — this needs a written quote for both the accepting and the paying leg.
- **Counterparty concentration.** The aggregator holds our working float and sits in the path of both revenue and payroll-adjacent payments. An outage stops both directions at once.
- **A layer of indirection.** Reconciliation runs against the aggregator's ledger rather than the wallet's.

What we gain beyond removing the bank

- Agents are not forced onto one wallet. An agent who uses GoPay is not a problem.
- Incoming sales fund outgoing commission directly, so there is no working-capital float to carry and no top-up step that a person can forget before a payout run.
- Customers can pay by any method rather than only DANA, which is likely to matter more for conversion than the payout question does.

06 Recommendation

If removing the bank account from the path is a firm requirement, the aggregator is the only option that is both documented and buildable now. It is also the only one that does not force a wallet choice onto our agents.

DANA remains the fastest thing to build and is worth keeping as the fallback if the bank-account constraint turns out to be softer than assumed. OVO direct is not recommended on its own merits — slower onboarding, worse top-up mechanics, and recipient limits that would push KYC work onto our agents — but the settlement-method question is worth asking, because a positive answer would change the conclusion.

Next actions

1. **Email OVO Business** (ovoforbusiness@ovo.id): does the settlement method allow disbursement without a prefunded deposit, and can incoming Payment API settlement offset outgoing Consumer Topup?
2. **Email the DANA account manager:** can Gapura settlement be directed to, or netted against, the Merchant Disbursement Account instead of a bank account?
3. **Request written pricing** from one aggregator for both legs: accepting e-wallet and QRIS payments, and paying out to e-wallets.
4. **Confirm the payout policy** before building: are agents paid to a wallet of their choosing, or to one nominated rail? This decides the integration, not the other way round.

Sources. DANA: Merchant Portal API documentation, mirrored at [ayo/GUIDES/DANA/](#) — business verification overview, payment services settlement file, disbursement to balance guide, check disbursement account API. OVO: [ovo.id/partner-integration](#) — Consumer Topup integration high level, technical documentation and FAQ; Payment API integration high level. Xendit: public API reference and product terms.

Fee figures are indicative only and are not quoted here; all pricing requires written confirmation from each provider. Onboarding timelines are the providers' own published SLAs and are not commitments.